

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠10

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 2♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥10

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥2

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥2

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2
 ♥ 9 4 2
 ♦ K Q 6
 ♣ 8 7 4 3 2

♠ Q 10 8 6 5 4

♥ Q 7 5 3

♦ 7

♣ A Q



♠ A 7 3

♥ J 10 8

♦ A 10 8 4 2

♣ 10 5

♠ K J

♥ A K 6

♦ J 9 5 3

♣ K J 9 6

Even with a 6-card ♠ suit NORTH uses Stayman because he also has a 4-card ♥ suit. Given a choice, playing a 4-4 Major fit is usually preferable to a 6-2 or even a 6-3 fit.

But here SOUTH doesn't have four ♥s so NORTH just bids the game where he knows the partnership holds eight trumps.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♥J			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 3
♥ Q 10 9 8 4 3
♦ K 5
♣ A 5

♠ J 5 2

♥ A 7

♦ Q 9 6 3

♣ J 9 4 2



♠ A 7

♥ K J 6 5

♦ A 8 4

♣ K Q 10 8

♠ 10 9 8 6 4

♥ 2

♦ J 10 7 2

♣ 7 6 3

EAST breaks the expected Transfer sequence by jumping to 3♥ instead of bidding just 2♥. This is called the "Super Accept" and it shows a hand with four of the trump suit with maximum point count.

WEST's ♣ bid and EAST's ♦ bid are Control bids, showing first round control of the suit that was bid.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♠10			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 4 2
 ♥ J 10 8 7
 ♦ 10 6 4 2
 ♣ K 10

♠ K J 10 3

♥ K 5

♦ A 9 3

♣ 8 7 4 2



♠ 8 7

♥ 6 4 2

♦ J 7 5

♣ Q J 9 5 3

♠ Q 9 6 5

♥ A Q 9 3

♦ K Q 8

♣ A 6

NORTH uses Stayman because he has a 4-card ♠ suit.

SOUTH's 2♥ response wasn't exactly what NORTH was hoping for, so NORTH decides to bid 3NT.

SOUTH absolutely knows that NORTH holds a 4-card Major - and also knows that it isn't ♥s. So SOUTH bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♥J			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 6
 ♥ A K 7 4
 ♦ A Q 5 3
 ♣ 10 9

♠ Q 8 5

♥ 10

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ K Q 8 7 5



♠ J 9 7 4

♥ Q 8 6 2

♦ 10 8 7 6

♣ 4

♠ K 3 2

♥ J 9 5 3

♦ J

♣ A J 6 3 2

EAST has a rotten hand, and many players would just pass 1NT.

But EAST figures that having WEST play any 4-4 fit would be better than 1NT so he bids 2♣, Stayman. This is called "Garbage Stayman", and you can see why.

WEST bids 2♥ and EAST passes. He would have passed either 2♠ or 2♦ also.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥			
All Pass			
2♥ by West			
Lead: ♥10			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ 10 6 4
♦ Q 9 3
♣ A 6 5 4 2

♠ A Q 6 2

♥ K J 8

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 8 7



♠ K J 7 3

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K 10 4

♣ Q 9 3

♠ 10 9 5

♥ A 7 3 2

♦ J 8 7 5

♣ J 10

Just having a 4-card Major doesn't mean you must automatically use Stayman.

Here SOUTH has a 4-card ♠ suit, but decides not to seek a 4-4 fit because his hand wouldn't have any ruffing values in a ♠ contract. He bids 3NT.

Notice that even though NORTH also has four ♠s the 4-4 fit is not useful to them in a ♠ contract because neither hand can ruff any losers.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥2

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 8 6 4

♥ Q 7 3

♦ A 6

♣ 10 8 4

♠ A 9 2

♥ A 9 6

♦ J 10 8 4

♣ Q 6 3



♠ K J 7

♥ K J 5 4

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A 5

♠ 5 3

♥ 10 8 2

♦ 9 5 2

♣ K J 9 7 2

WEST has an invitational (9 point) hand with five ♠s.

She bids it in the standard way - first transfer EAST to ♠s, then invite the game by bidding 2NT.

EAST, with 17 points and three ♠s, accepts the game invitation and chooses 4♠.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♥2